

UI & UX Design
SWE 4833

**Observing Insights from Usability Study
& Card Sorting**

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Make Insights from observations

- Step 1- Gather all of the data from usability study in one place.
- Step 2: Organize the data.
- Step 3: Patterns and themes in research data
- Step 4: Come up with insights for each theme

Gather and organize data

- If you wrote your observations on sticky notes, you might use a method called affinity diagramming to organize your data.
- If you used spreadsheet notetaking to record your observations, you've already started organizing the data without even realizing it.

Affinity diagramming

An affinity diagram is a method of synthesizing that organizes data into groups with common themes or relationships.

A#1- Notes for each participants according to task (Dog Walker)

A: Confused about "Schedule" button vs "Dog walkers near you"	A: Wants to schedule using a calendar	A: Doesn't know who to choose or how to choose the best dog-walker from the list.	A: Frustrated that there's no confirmation page	A: Couldn't complete Prompt 4 because "Address" wasn't visible anywhere.	A: Wants a way to book a dog-walker every Saturday
B: Confused about what to press on the home screen	B: Commented on number of options for dog walkers	B: Wants to be able to book a dog-walker repeatedly.	B: re: Prompt 3 "That was super easy!"		
C: Thinks tips are useful on home screen	C: Scheduling a dog-walker was easy with the big button	C: Chooses dog-walker based on proximity	C: re: booking message "This message here is so upbeat!"	C: Wants a confirmation page	C: Wants to book a recurring dog walker
D: Confused about "Dog walkers near you" button and "Schedule" button	D: Wants a calendar to schedule date and time for the dog-walker	D: Doesn't know who to pick because of lacking details	D: Expected an add to cart button	D: Surprised there's no booking confirmation page	D: "I was just clicking on different buttons to try and figure it out?"
E: Wants to book multiple dog-walker sessions	E: Confused about how to select a dog-walker from the list	E: Annoyed that there wasn't a confirmation page before booking.	E: Wants to filter dog-walkers by experience level		

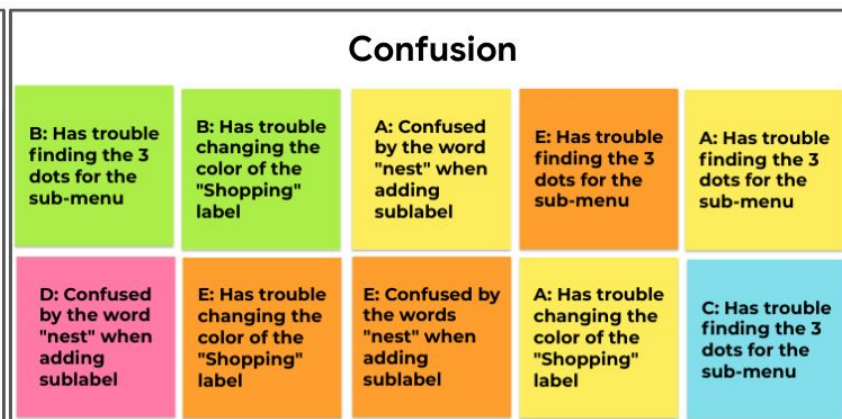
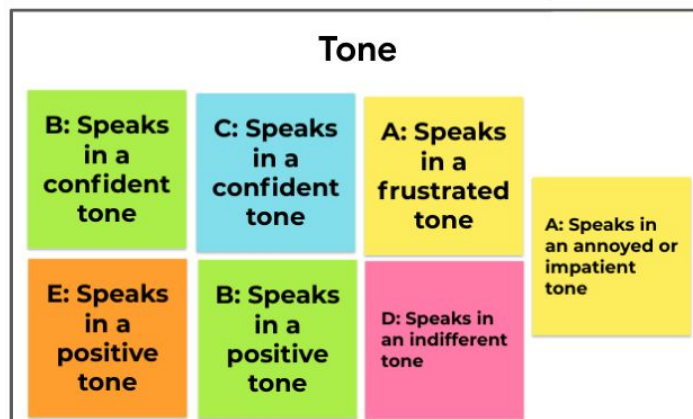
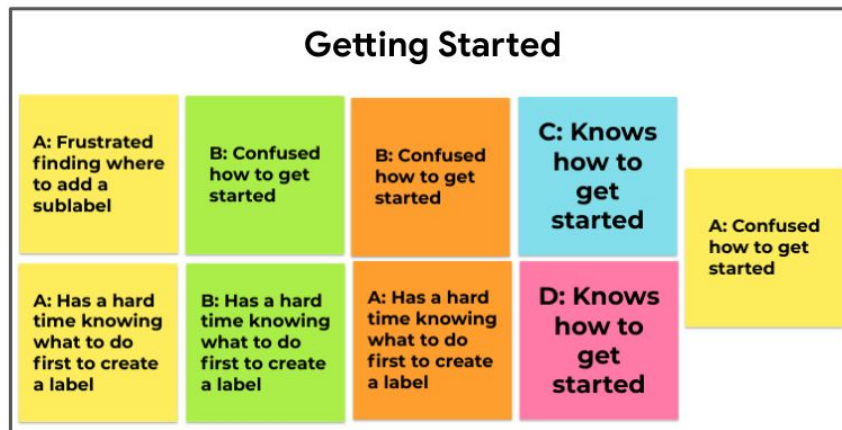
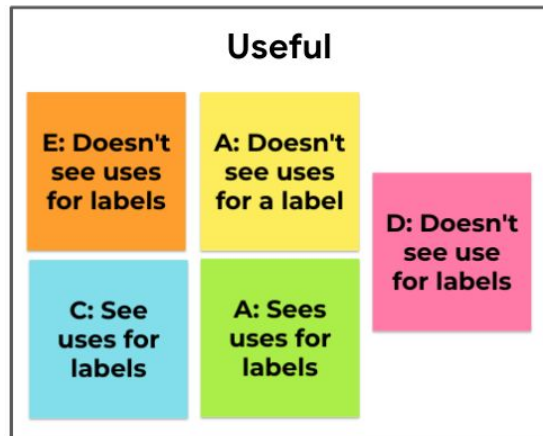
A#2- Put sticky notes in groups (Dog Walker)



A#3- Continue until there are no sticky notes remaining

A#4- Do a second review

Sort through research data (Gmail label)



Patterns and themes in research data

- Areas of the affinity diagram with multiple sticky notes usually represent a pattern and later each pattern becomes a theme.

1. It was observed that 4 out of 5 participants had trouble finding the 3 dot sub-menu. This means that the 3 dot sub-menu is difficult to find for almost all users.
2. It was observed that 3 out of 5 participants had a hard time knowing what to do first to create a label. This means that for most users, it's not immediately clear how to create a new label.
3. It was observed that 3 out of 5 participants saw a use for labels. This means that labels are useful for most people, but not an overwhelming majority.
4. It was observed that 3 out of 5 participants were confused by the word "nest" when adding a sublabel. This means that not everyone is familiar with the term "nesting" or this specific use.
5. It was observed that 3 out of 5 participants had trouble changing the color of the "shopping" label. This means that most users were unsure how to change the color of a label.

1. Based on the theme that: for most users, it's not immediately clear how to create a new label, an insight is: users need better cues for what steps are required to create a label.
2. Based on the theme that: the 3 dot sub-menu is difficult to find for almost all users, an insight is: users need a more intuitive way to access label settings.
3. Based on the theme that: labels are useful for most people, but not an overwhelming majority, an insight is: users need more information about the potential value of using Gmail labels.
4. Based on the theme that: not everyone is familiar with the term "nesting" or this specific use, an insight is: use accessible language (avoid jargon) when explaining uses for the Gmail labels feature.
5. Based on the theme that: most users were unsure how to change the color of a label, an insight is: users need better cues for what steps are required to change the color of a label.

Qualities of strong insights

- Grounded in real data
- Supported by multiple pieces of data
- Need to answer the research questions listed in research plan
- Easy to understand
- Increase empathy for the user experience
- Inspire direct action

Card Sorting

Card Sorting

One of the biggest UX problems identified by users is that the information they're seeking from a product is not where they expect to find it.

Card sorting is a UX research technique in which research participants sort labels for content into larger categories. Card sorting provides insight into how participants group a product's content, enabling the UX team to design an information architecture that makes sense to users.

Card Sorting

For example, if you're creating a website for a store that sells office products and services, how do you organise the categories on the website to encompass everything that's offered in a way that the user can understand?

Do you have a category specifically for school supplies, under which you place every item a student might require for the academic year or does it make more sense to include separate categories for supplies like pens, folders and notebooks?

Card sorting enables you to see how users would organise the information. If you conduct a card sort with multiple participants, you'll see patterns emerge that will help you organise the product's information architecture in a way that will make the most sense to your users.

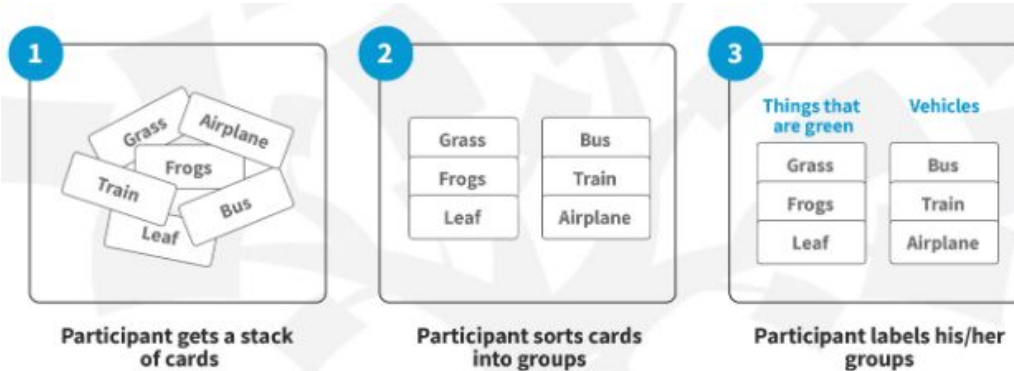
In-Person vs. Remote Card Sorting

- Card sorting can be conducted in person or remotely.
- **In-person** participants use physical index cards.
- **Remote** participants use digital cards via web-based tools like Optimal Sort.

Different types of card sorting

Open card sort:

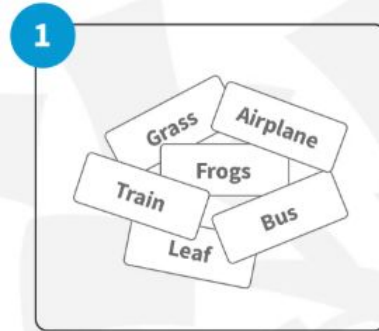
In an open card sort, participants organise a set of cards into categories. They then label each category with whatever name they think fits it best. Open card sorts help you to understand not only how users organise content but also the terms they use to classify these items.



Different types of card sorting

Closed card sort:

In a closed card sort, participants organise a set of cards into a predetermined group of categories. Closed card sorts help you to validate a group of categories that have already been defined by the UX team. Closed card sorting will shed light on whether a set of predetermined categories are understood by users and if they agree on what content belongs in each category.



Participant gets a stack of cards



Participant sorts cards into groups the researchers have created

Different types of card sorting

Hybrid card sort:

In a hybrid card sort, participants are given a predetermined group of categories that users can organise their cards into but it also enables participants to create and label new categories if they want to. Hybrid card sorts help you to discover if users understand a predetermined set of categories. If not, the users will inform you on how they would prefer the content to be categorised.